

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 7 5 3
♥ 8 6
♦ 10 7
♣ 10 6 4 3

♠ 6

♥ A K Q J 10

♦ A 8 5 4 3

♣ K J



♠ 10 9 2

♥ 9 7 4 2

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q 9

♠ K Q 8 4

♥ 5 3

♦ 6 2

♣ A 8 7 5 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

Click

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♣3.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=5 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 8

You only need one more winner and your ♠ K Q will provide it. So, is there anything that could go wrong? - - Like could you mess up your entry?

Click

Suppose you play the ♣J from dummy on the first trick. And then suppose West puts the ♣Q on. If you take your ♣A you have used your entry to the ♠ K Q before you established one of them. But if you don't take the trick East will play another ♣ to remove dummy's ♣K with the same effect. So what should you do?

It's easy once you think about it. Just win the opening lead with dummy's ♣K. Then, while it's fresh in your mind play to your ♠ K Q to establish the one extra winner you need. Then it's just a question of taking your winners.

Hasty play to the first trick is one of the weaknesses of losing bridge players.

Making a plan before they play to the first trick is one of the strengths of winning bridge players.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 2
 ♥ 10 8 3
 ♦ K 10 8 5 2
 ♣ 7 4

♠ 7 6 5

♥ 6 2

♦ Q J 9

♣ J 10 9 8 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 8 3

♥ Q J 9 7

♦ 7 4

♣ A 6 2

♠ A J 4

♥ A K 5 4

♦ A 6 3

♣ K Q 3

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♦ 5. You play the ♦ 9 from dummy and East plays the ♦ 4.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=2 ♣=0 Total = 5

The bad news is that you must come up with 4 more winners! The good news is dummy's ♣ suit.

You can drive out the ♣ A, then get over to dummy for those ♣ winners. You will be able to get over to dummy, won't you?

Click

Not if you let the ♦ 9 hold the first trick. The defender with the ♣ A will hold it up until the third round, then West will be able to play his ♦ K so as to prevent you from entering dummy.

But take first trick with the ♦ A and the ♦ Q J will be there guaranteeing you an entry to those two good ♣s.

It goes against the grain to put your ♦ A on a trick that dummy has already won with the ♦ 9. It seems like you are wasting a trick.

But look carefully at the ♦ situation. You are going to get exactly two ♦ tricks no matter when you play your ♦ A. So you don't lose a trick, but you do gain an entry.